NAILED BY SEMA

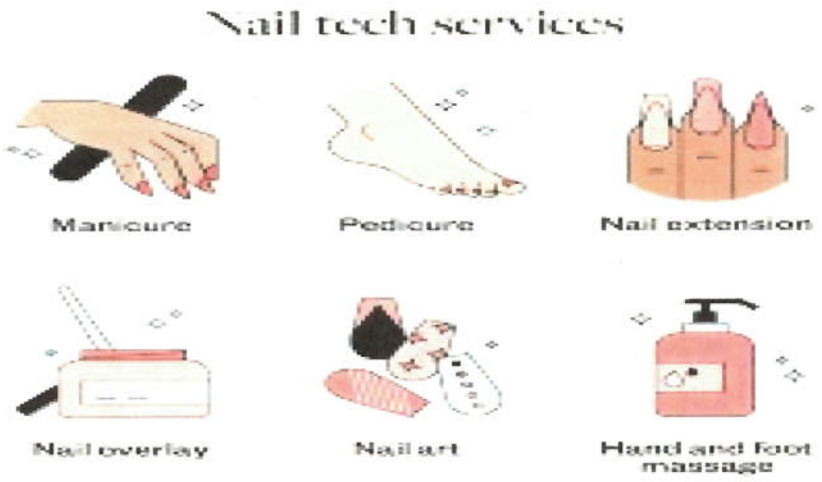
NAILS TRAINING HANDOUT

LOCATION: ***KTU ROAD ADJACENT LUMEN BAR***

CONTACT: 0539649949

NAIL TECHNOLOGY TRAINING 2026

1. Introduction to Nail Technology



Nail technology is the specialized art of cleaning, decorating, and enhancing the appearance of fingernails, hands, toenails, and feet. It covers techniques like manicures, pedicures, and artificial nail application (acrylics,Stickons , polygels, builder gels) Technicians must master sanitation, anatomy, and product chemistry to ensure safe, high-quality service.

Key Aspects of Nail Technology

* Essential Services: Basic manicures/pedicures, filing, shaping, and applying polish.
* Nail Enhancements: Application of acrylic (liquid/powder) and gel systems (UV/LED cured) to strengthen or extend nails.
* Art & Design: Techniques such as hand-painting, 3D art, chrome finishes, and ombre effects.
* Health & Safety: Maintaining strict hygiene, sterilizing tools, and identifying potential nail/skin disorders.
* Anatomy: Understanding the structure of the nail plate, cuticle, and skin.

Core Skills for Beginners

- Nail Preparation: Properly pushing back the cuticle, removing the dead tissue (cuticle), and dehydrating the nail plate for, longevity.
* Tool Handling: Using files, nippers, and electric files (e-files) safely.
* Client Consultation: Communicating with clients to understand their needs and assessing nail health.

The Role of a Nail Technician

A nail technician, or nail stylist, works in salons, spas, or independently. Key responsibilities include creating a safe environment, delivering high-quality, long-lasting nail designs, and offering excellent customer service.

2. Nail Anatomy

Nail anatomy consists of the visible, hard, keratinized nail plate (or body), which grows from the underlying nail matrix (the root). The plate rests on the nail bed. Surrounding structures include the eponychium (cuticle), paronychium(side walls), and the lunula (visible part of the matrix). The entire unit protects sensitive fingertips.

Cleveland Clinic

* Nail Plate (Body): The visible, hard, translucent part made of approximately 50 layers of compressed, dead keratin cells. It is not living and has no nerves or blood vessels.

* Nail Matrix: Located under the skin at the base (proximal fold), this is where new cells are produced. Damage here can cause permanent nail abnormalities.

* Lunula: The white, half-moon shape at the base of the nail, which is the visible portion of the matrix.

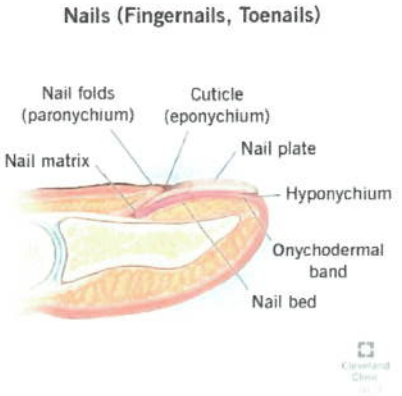
* Nail Bed: The skin underneath the nail plate, which contains blood vessels that give the nail its pinkish color.

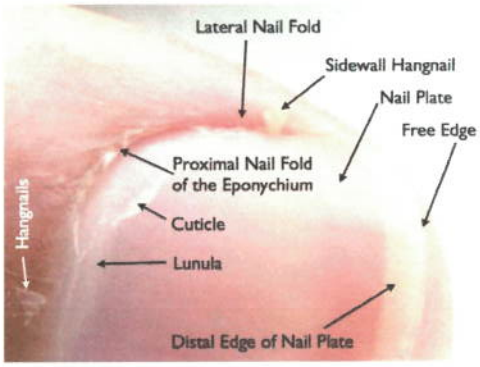
* Cuticle/Eponychium: The eponychium is the living skin at the base of the nail, while the cuticle is the dead, shedding skin that adheres to the nail plate.

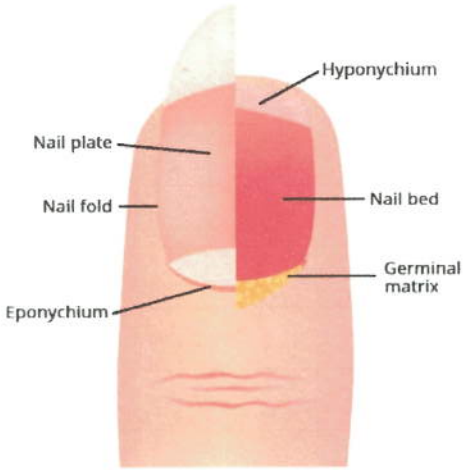
* Hyponychium: The area of skin under the free edge of the nail, which acts as a seal to protect the nail bed.

* Free Edge: The part of the nail plate that extends past the fingertip.

* Paronychium/Lateral Nail Folds: The skin that frames the sides of the nail.







3. Nail Extensions

What are nail extensions?

Nail extensions are artificial enhancements applied to natural nails to increase their length, strength, and durability, typically lasting several weeks. Common methods include acrylics (liquid and powder), hard gel, polygel, and soft gel tips, which can be sculpted or applied via tips, allowing for customized shapes like almond, coffin, or square.

Common Types of Nail Extensions

* Acrylic Nails: A durable mixture of liquid monomer and powder polymer that creates a strong, air-dried layer over the natural nail.

* Hard Gel Extensions: A thick gel cured under a UV lamp, often seen as more flexible and natural-looking than acrylics.

* Soft Gel Tips (Gel-X): Pre-shaped tips applied with gel and cured, offering a faster application, often preferred for a lighter feel.

* Polygel: A hybrid formula that combines the flexibility of gel with the strength of acrylic.

Application and Maintenance

* Application Process: Technicians prepare the natural nail, apply a tip or a form, and then apply the chosen material (acrylic/gel) to build the desired length and shape.

* Maintenance: Extensions require "fills" or "refills" every 2–3 weeks to manage the growth at the cuticle area.

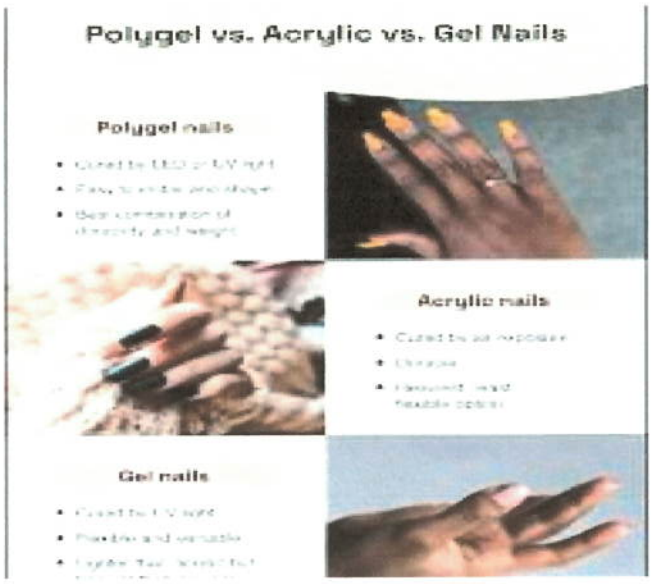
* Removal: Proper, professional removal is necessary to avoid damaging the natural nail underneath.

Pros and Cons

* Pros: Instantly adds length, strengthens brittle nails, and provides a long-lasting, durable finish.

* Cons: Requires regular, ongoing maintenance and can cause damage if improperly applied or removed

6. Product Knowledge



Nail products include essential prep tools (cuticle pushers, files), enhancement systems (acrylic, gel, dip powder), and safety equipment (LED/UV lamps, ventilation). Acrylic involves mixing liquid monomer and powder, while gels require UV/LED curing. Proper knowledge of nail plate anatomy, safe product usage, and hygiene is crucial for preventing infections, allergies, and damage.

Key Nail Product Categories

* Prep Tools: Cuticle pushers (stainless steel), cuticle nippers, nail files (180/240 grit), buffers, and dehydrators/primers.
* Acrylic System: Involves monomer (liquid) and polymer (powder) that air-dries, requiring high-quality brushes for application.
* Gel System: Pre-mixed gel (hard gel, soft gel, or polish) cured under UV or LED lamps, offering a high-gloss finish.
* Dip Powder: Base coat, activator, and colored acrylic powder, providing durability without the need for sculpting, often considered a lighter alternative to acrylic.
* Finishing & Care: Topcoats (glossy/matte), cuticle oil to hydrate skin, and nail polish remover (acetone).
* Tools: Nail clippers, e-files (for professionals), and UV/LED lamps.

Safety and Application Knowledge

* Safety First: Many nail products are flammable; ensure good ventilation and avoid eye contact.
* Application: Proper surface prep is crucial for adhesion. Acrylic requires mastering powder-to-liquid ratios. Gel must be cured for the correct time to avoid under-curing, which can lead to allergic reactions.
* Removal: Incorrect removal (peeling or improper filing) is the main cause of damage to the natural nail plate.
* Product Knowledge: Understanding the difference between HEMA-free (hydroxyethyl methacrylate) products and traditional gels can reduce allergic reactions.
*
* NailKnowledge

Commonly Used Tools

* Brushes: Specialized, high-quality kolinsky brushes for acrylic and flat brushes for gel application.
* Files: Various grits (80-240) for shaping natural nails, refining extensions, and buffing.

Understanding the chemical and physical properties of these products ensures long-lasting, safe, and professional-looking manicures.

Gel polish

Gel polish is a durable, high-shine nail formula cured under UV or LED light, lasting 2–3 weeks without chipping. It requires a base coat, color layers, and a top coat, with each layer cured (typically 30–60 seconds). Unlike traditional polish, it dries instantly and requires soaking in acetone for removal

Key Aspects of Gel Polish

* Application: Involves rigorous prep (buffing, dehydrating) to ensure adhesion, followed by thin layers of base, color, and top coat, each cured under a lamp.
* Curing: Requires a UV or LED lamp to harden; it will not air dry.
* Removal: Must be soaked off with acetone (approx. 10–15 minutes) rather than chipped off, which can damage natural nails.
* Benefits: Offers a long-lasting, glossy, and chip-resistant finish

Common Mistakes to Avoid

* Applying too thick: Thin layers are essential for proper curing and avoiding lifting.
* Skipping Prep: Failing to buff the nail or remove cuticles causes premature peeling.
* Touching Skin: Gel on the skin can cause lifting and skin irritation.

Robber Base Gel

Rubber base gel is a thick, flexible, and self-leveling soak-off base coat designed to strengthen, protect, and add structure to natural nails, especially weak, thin, or brittle ones. It acts as a durable, rubber-like foundation that cures under UV/LED light to prevent bending, lifting, and breakage while promoting healthier nail growth.

Key Characteristics and Benefits

* Flexibility & Strength: Unlike hard gels, rubber base bends with the natural nail, which prevents chipping and cracking.
* Self-Leveling & Thick Consistency: The thicker, self-leveling, viscous formula fills in ridges and creates a perfect, smooth, and reinforced "apex".
* Superior Adhesion: It is designed to adhere strongly to the natural nail, reducing lifting issues.
* Versatility: It can be used alone for a natural look (it comes in clear and nude, sheer, or pink shades) or as a base for gel polish.
* Application: It is typically applied to prepped nails in a thin layer, followed by a thicker bead for sculpting, and cured for 60 seconds.

Rubber Base vs. Builder Gel

While both strengthen, rubber base is more flexible and better suited for very bendy, thin, or short-to-medium nails. Builder gel is more rigid, harder, and better for longer nails or extensions.

Usage Tips

* Prep: Proper prep, including removing cuticles and buffing, is critical to avoid lifting.
* Refills: Instead of a full soak-off, you can fill in the outgrowth every 3 weeks.
* Removal: It is a soak-off product, usually removed with acetone.

Common Uses

* Strengthening weak/bendy nails

* Creating a natural, healthy-looking manicure
* Smoothing out uneven, ridged nails
* Improving adhesion for long-lasting manicures

BUILDER GEL

Builder gel is a thick-viscosity UV/LED nail product designed to strengthen, protect, and extend natural nails. It acts as a durable, flexible, and often self-leveling overlay that prevents breaking and allows for growth, typically lasting 3-4 weeks. Commonly available as BIAB (Builder In A Bottle), it is applied similarly to polish but with added structure.

Key Aspects of Builder Gel:
* Purpose: Strengthens natural nails and adds length, offering a more durable alternative to standard gel polish.
* Application: Can be applied in thin layers for overlays or thicker layers to build an apex (the thickest, highest point of the nail) for strength.
* Types: Primarily, there is BIAB (soak-off) and hard gel (requires filing to remove).
* Colors: Available in clear, nude, white, and pink shades.
* Removal: Most commonly used, such as Gelous

How to Apply (General Steps):
1. Prep: Clean, buff, and dehydrate the natural nail.
2. Base Coat: Apply a base gel and cure.
3. Application: Apply a "slip layer" (a thin coat) followed by a larger bead to build structure and shape, allowing it to self-level.
4. Cure: Cure under a UV/LED lamp.
5. Finish: File/buff to shape and apply a top coat.

POLY GEL

PolyGel is a durable, lightweight, and odorless hybrid nail enhancement—combining acrylic powder with clear gel—that is ideal for both extensions and overlays. It offers a flexible, easy-to-mold formula that lasts 3-4 weeks, making it popular for DIY at-home applications. PolyGel requires curing under a LED or UV lamp.

Key Features and Benefits
* Consistency: Unlike traditional acrylic, PolyGel has a thick, putty-like consistency that won't run, allowing it to be applied to all nails before curing.
* Strength & Weight: It is 30% stronger than standard acrylics and 50% lighter, providing a natural look without added bulk.
* Ease of Use: It is considered beginner-friendly as it does not require mixing liquids and powders.

Application Process
1. Prep: Clean, shape, and dehydrate natural nails.
2. Base Coat: Apply a thin layer of gel base coat and cure.
3. Application: Squeeze the PolyGel from the tube, slice it with a specialized tool, and place it on the nail or a dual form.
4. Shape: Use a brush dipped in Slip Solution to shape and smooth the gel without it sticking to the brush.
5. Cure: Cure under a LED lamp for 60 seconds (or 2 minutes for UV).
6. Finish: File, shape, and apply a top coat for a high-gloss finish.

Removal
PolyGel is removed similarly to gel polish: file down the top layer, soak in acetone, and gently scrape off.

Acrylic nails;

Acrylic nails are durable, artificial nail enhancements created by mixing a liquid monomer and powder polymer to form a hard protective layer over natural nails or tips. They allow for versatile shaping and last 2-3 weeks before requiring a fill-in. While offering strength, they require professional application or careful DIY techniques to prevent damage to the natural nail.

Key Aspects of Acrylic Nails:
* Application Process: A technician applies a liquid monomer and powder polymer, which air-dries into a solid, clear, or colored layer. Tips or forms are used to extend length.
* Maintenance: "Fill-ins" or "rebalances" are required every two to three weeks to cover the gap at the cuticle caused by nail growth.
* Safety & Durability: While strong, acrylics can cause weakness in natural nails if not removed properly or if applied too harshly. The use of MMA (methyl methacrylate) should be avoided; EMA (ethyl methacrylate) is the safe, recommended monomer.
* Shapes & Styles: Popular shapes include round, oval, almond, square, coffin/ballerina, and stiletto.
* Removal: Acrylics should be soaked off in acetone to avoid damaging the natural nail.

Tips for Maintenance:
* Wear gloves for heavy-duty tasks to prevent damage.
* Apply cuticle oil regularly to keep skin and nails healthy.
* Avoid using nails as tools to prevent lifting and breakage.

Nail dehydrator ;

A nail dehydrator is a vital, quick-drying, and often alcohol-based, liquid applied to natural nails to remove surface oils and moisture. By temporarily removing these, it ensures maximum adhesion for nail enhancements (acrylic, gel, polish), preventing lifting and improving longevity. It should be applied after cleaning/filing but before primer.

Key Aspects of Nail Dehydrator:
* Purpose: Eliminates oil and moisture on the nail plate to prevent lifting and improve product adhesion.
* When to Apply: Used after filing, buffing, and cleaning the nails but before applying primer or bonder.
* Application: Generally painted on and allowed to air dry for about 10–30 seconds until the nail looks chalky or dull.
* Ingredients: Often contains isopropyl alcohol, ethyl acetate, or butyl acetate.
* Versatility: Essential for gel manicures, acrylic, and press-on nails.
* Alternatives: 91% or higher rubbing alcohol or pure acetone can work similarly to a professional nail dehydrator.

Nail primer

Nail primer is a crucial, usually non-curable, liquid agent applied to natural nails to remove oils, balance pH, and enhance the adhesion of acrylic, gel, or gel polish, preventing premature lifting and chipping. It acts as a double-sided tape for enhancements, typically applied after a nail dehydrator.

Key Aspects of Nail Primer

* Purpose: Increases the longevity of manicures by securing the product to the nail plate.
* Types:
  * Acid-Free Primer: The most common, gentle, and universal, suitable for most clients.
  * Acid Primer: Used for "problematic" oily nails or those prone to lifting, as it creates microscopic, stronger adhesion.
* Application: Applied after dehydrator and before base coat; it usually dries to a slightly tacky texture without needing to be cured under a lamp.
* Difference from Dehydrator: A dehydrator removes moisture and oils, while the primer creates a chemical bond

Usage Tips

* Avoid Skin: Apply carefully to the natural nail only, as primers can cause irritation if they contact the skin.
* Less is More: Use a small amount to avoid flooding the cuticles.
* Sequence: Dehydrator

NAILS SHAPE

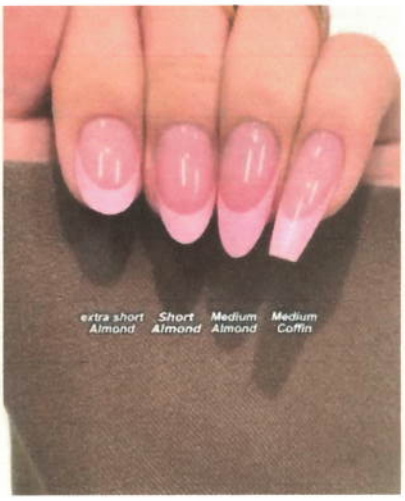
Common nail shapes include square, round, oval, almond, coffin/ballerina, and stiletto, each offering a distinct aesthetic ranging from natural to dramatic. Popular choices include the low-maintenance, classic oval, the modern, tapered coffin, and the bold, long stiletto. Choosing the right shape depends on finger length, nails

Common Nail Shapes and Their Features

* Square: Straight sides with a sharp, flat tip, providing a sturdy, modern look often best for shorter nails.
* Round: A classic, simple shape that mimics the natural contour of the nail bed, ideal for short nails and low maintenance.
* Oval: Similar to round but more tapered, creating the illusion of longer fingers.
* Squoval: A hybrid of square and oval, offering a straight, flat edge with soft, rounded corners.
* Almond: Tapered along the sides with a rounded, slim tip, best suited for longer, durable nails.
*
* Coffin/Ballerina: A dramatic, long shape featuring straight, tapered sides that end in a squared-off tip.
* Stiletto: A long, pointed, dramatic shape that requires strong nails.
* Lipstick: A unique, sharp diagonal, angled tip.

Choosing the Right Shape

* Short Nails: Square or round shapes are often best for maintaining strength.
* Wide Nail Beds: Oval, almond, and squoval can help create a slimming effect.
* Long Fingers: Square or coffin shapes complement longer, slender fingers.
* Low Maintenance: Rounded, shorter nails are less likely to snag or break.



God's Nails retention

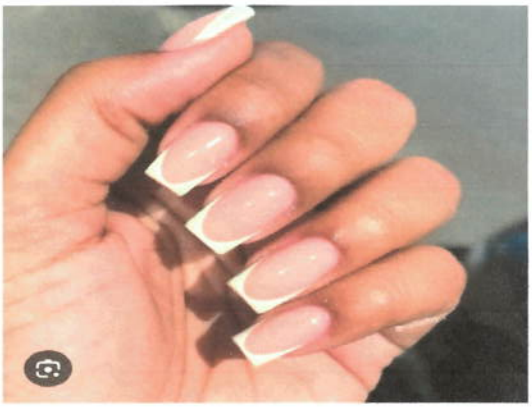
Good nail retention means artificial nail enhancements (gels, acrylics, dips) last 3–6 weeks without lifting, peeling, or popping off. Achieving this requires meticulous cuticle,, and nail surface preparation, proper product application, and avoiding cuticle flooding to ensure a strong, long-lasting bond.

Key Factors for Maximum Retention:
* Thorough Prep: Remove all invisible dead skin (cuticle) from the nail plate and dehydrate the nail thoroughly.
* Proper Technique: Avoid touching the skin or cuticle with product; "flush" the product at the cuticle and side walls to prevent lifting.
* Product Application: Use the correct liquid-to-powder ratio for acrylics and avoid applying gels too thickly.
* Maintenance: Get fills every 2–3 weeks to maintain structural integrity.
*
* Protection: Wear gloves when cleaning or doing dishes to prevent water from lifting the product.
*
* Signs of Good Retention:
* No lifting at the cuticle area.
* No nails popping off.
* The set lasts 4+ weeks.

What Causes Poor Retention:
* Skipping Primer: Not using a proper primer or dehydrator.
* Improper Prep: Leaving oils or dead skin on the nail plate.
* Flooding the Cuticle: Applying product onto the skin, which causes lifting as the nail grows.
* Improper Ratio: Inconsistent acrylic liquid-to-powder ratio.

What are French tips on nails?

french tip nails are a staple nail design that has been around since the 1930s. consisting of a sheer pink base color and a white tip, this nail look is timelessly chic.



Chrome nails

Chrome nails are a popular, high-gloss manicure trend featuring a, shiny, metallic, or pearly mirror-like effect, achieved by buffing specialized ultra-fine powder pigments over gel polish. Popularized for their futuristic, liquid-metal look, they can range from intense metallic finishes to soft, pearly "glazed" effects, such as the famous Hailey Bieber nail trend.

Key Aspects of Chrome Nails:

Application: A specialized, non-wipe top coat is applied, cured, and then the chrome powder is rubbed or "burnished" onto the nail surface.

Versatility: While silver and gold are common, chrome powders come in many colors (pink, blue, purple) and effects, including holographic and pearly finishes.

Longevity: They are typically done with gel polish, making them long-lasting, though they require careful application to avoid chipping.

Popular Styles: Common styles include full-coverage mirror nails, French manicures with chrome tips, and "glazed donut" nails, which use a white or nude chrome powder over a neutral base. Chrome nails can be applied to natural nails, acrylics, or gel extensions to add a luxurious, reflective, and trend-focused look to any manicure

Cateye nails

Cat Eye Nail Art Trend Is Inspired by Winged Liner — Photos | Allure

Cat eye nails are a popular,, mesmerizing manicure style created by using special magnetic gel polish filled with metallic particles. A magnet is held over the wet polish, forcing the metal to shift and form a shimmering, diagonal line or 3D effect that mimics a cat's eye or velvet.

Key Features of Cat Eye Nails:

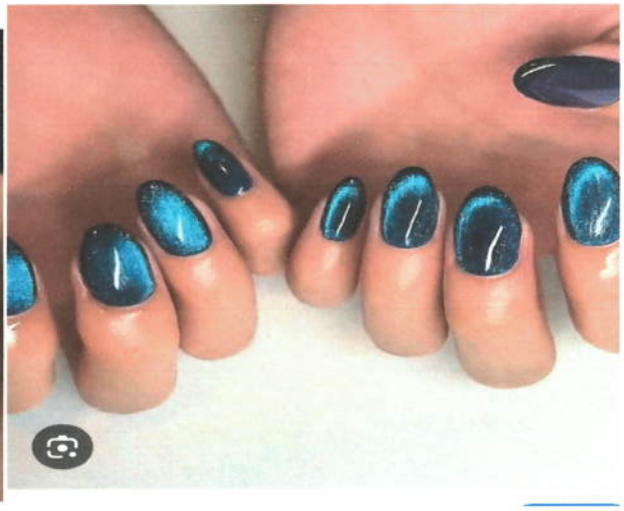
Dynamic Appearance: The light-reflecting streak changes position depending on the angle of the light and hand movement.

Magnetic Application: Metallic pigments are manipulated with a magnet to create unique, customizable designs, such as diagonal lines, swirls, or crescents.

Versatile Look: They offer a luxurious, shimmering finish that can be bold or subtle, often referred to as "velvet nails" or "magnetic nails".

Application Process: The magnetic polish is applied in a, slightly thicker coat than normal, then a magnet is moved over it to create the effect before curing under a UV/LED lamp.

Cat eye nails are popular for their ability to shift in color and intensity, providing a, sophisticated and, trendy look.



Oral nails

Oral" or, more commonly, coral nail designs feature vibrant shades ranging from pinkish-orange to deep salmon, ideal for summer, and are often paired with white, gold, or holographic accents. Popular styles include ombre, French tips, marble, and floral accents, often applied on acrylic or gel, creating a bright, warm-weather aesthetic.

Key Types of Coral/Oral Nail Designs

Coral Ombre: A gradient effect, often blending colors like "dreamy," "breakthrough" glitter, and "pure pink" for a multi-dimensional look.

French Tips: Classic or modern twists, such as using bright coral tips instead of traditional white.

3D Art & Embellishments: Incorporating pearls, gems, or studs on a coral base for added texture.

Aura/Jelly Nails: Airbrushed, soft-serve, or sheer "jelly" coral polishes for a trendy, soft look.

Patterned: Designs featuring coral mixed with animal prints (like leopard) or geometric, abstract shapes.

Popular Techniques & Combinations

Color Blocking: Mixing coral with grey or gold, often for a more artistic look.

Finish Options: Ranging from high-gloss to matte, often enhanced with gold foil.

Shape & Length: These colors are often used on almond or long stiletto nails to accentuate the vibrant color.

For a full application, techniques often involve careful preparation, including cuticle care with a "cuticle buster" or drill, followed by applying, shaping, and blending acrylic or gel, finished with a glossy top coat.

Symptoms of Nail Infections

Fungal Infection (Onychomycosis): Thickened, brittle, or ragged nails that may be discolored (white, yellow, brown, or green). The nail may become distorted, separated from the nail bed, or produce a foul odor.

Bacterial Infection (Paronychia): Rapidly developing, painful, red, and swollen skin around the nail, often with pus-filled blisters.

Causes and Risk Factors

Causes: Fungal infections often spread from athlete's foot, while bacterial infections (paronychia) occur when bacteria enter skin cuts around the nail, often from biting or aggressive manicures.

Risk Factors: Increased age, diabetes, poor circulation, weakened immune systems, and frequently wet feet (e.g., from sweaty shoes or public showers).

Treatment and Prevention

Treatment: Antifungal creams or oral medications are used for fungi, while antibiotic creams or oral pills are used for bacteria. Severe cases may require removing the nail or abscess drainage.

Prevention: Keep feet clean and dry, wear sandals in public showers/pools, keep nails trimmed, and avoid sharing nail clippers or shoes

Key Symptoms and Causes

Symptoms: Thickened, brittle, crumbly, or ragged nails; yellow, white, or green discoloration; dark spots; and separation from the nail bed (onycholysis).

Causes: Fungal infections often start from athlete's foot spreading to the toenail. Bacterial infections thrive in moist environments, such as from constant water exposure or artificial nail products.

Medical News Today

Medical News Today

Treatment Approaches

Topical/Oral Medications: Antifungal creams, lacquers, or pills are common for fungal infections.

Nail Removal: Severe infections may require removal of the nail.

Environmental Changes: Keeping nails dry, disinfecting tools, and avoiding sharing files helps prevent recurrence.